Mounded together in the center of the bowl, the vegetables in this soup resemble coins—which is one of the reasons it got its name. The other is that it is very inexpensive to make.

"penny" soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 30 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
WITH ALL VEGETABLES BLENDED

1 leek, rinsed well
11oz (300g) potatoes
9oz (250g) large carrots
6oz (175g) small sweet potatoes
1 tbsp olive oil
1 tbsp butter
2 cups hot vegetable stock
1 tbsp chopped flat-leaf parsley
salt and freshly ground black pepper

1 Slice the vegetables into ⅛in (3mm) rounds. Heat the oil and butter in a large saucepan, add the leeks, and cook over medium heat, stirring frequently, for 3–4 minutes or until soft. Add the potatoes, carrots, and sweet potatoes and cook, stirring, for 1 minute.

2 Pour in the stock, then bring to a boil, cover with a lid, and simmer for 20 minutes or until the vegetables are tender but not soft. Transfer about one-third of the vegetables to a blender or food processor with a little of the liquid and blend to a smooth purée, then return to the pan. Stir in the parsley, season to taste with salt and freshly ground black pepper, and serve, with the vegetables in a little mound in the center.